Benasing Macarambon Jr.

Benasing Onayan Macarambon Jr. is a Bangsamoro politician and public servant who served as Representative of the 2nd District of Lanao del Sur in the House of Representatives of the Philippines for three consecutive terms from 1998 to 2007.

He is a leader of the Moro National Liberation Front (MNLF) and a longtime advocate for the ecological protection of Lake Lanao.

His career spans regional assembly service, three terms in the national legislature, a gubernatorial bid, and a post-congressional appointment to the Subic Bay Metropolitan Authority (SBMA) board.

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BACKGROUND

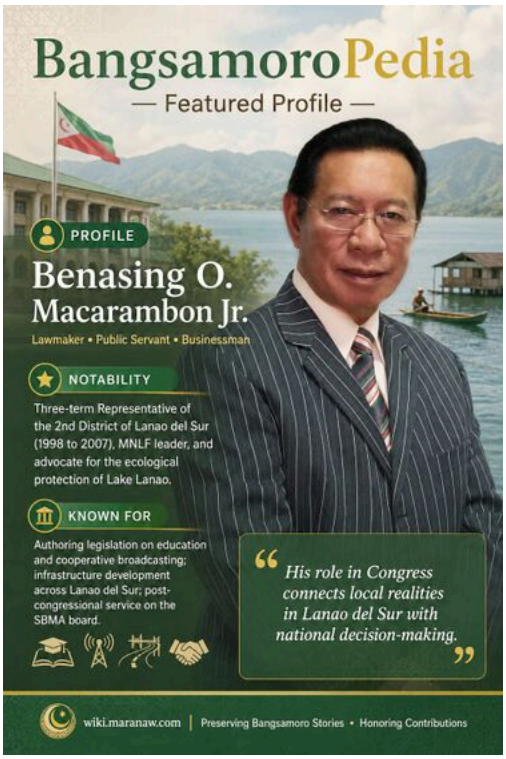
Macarambon was born in Lanao del Sur, Philippines.

He comes from a prominent family in the province.

The Macarambon family is associated with Fiat Construction Services, one of the largest construction firms in Mindanao.

His public service began well before his congressional career, rooted in regional governance structures that predated the formal ARMM.

Benasing Onayan Macarambon Jr.



Personal Information

Born: Lanao del Sur, Philippines

Ethnicity / Identity

Bangsamoro

Profession

Politician; Public Servant; Businessman

Political Affiliation

EARLY GOVERNMENT SERVICE

On December 29, 1987, Macarambon was designated by then-Secretary of Local Government Luis T. Santos as a member of the Sangguniang Pampook (Regional Assembly) in Region XII.

The Sangguniang Pampook was an interim regional body that operated under the framework of regional autonomy in Muslim Mindanao prior to the formal establishment of the ARMM.

His tenure in that body ended when it was abolished by the enactment of Republic Act No. 6734 in 1989, which set the stage for the 1990 ARMM elections.

ARMM REGIONAL LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY

Macarambon later served as Assemblyman for the 2nd District of Lanao del Sur in the 3rd ARMM Regional Legislative Assembly, which sat from 1996 to 2001.

This regional legislative experience gave him direct exposure to the governance challenges of Muslim Mindanao, including questions of autonomy, development funding, and the administration of communities with distinct cultural and religious identities.

MEMBER OF THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Macarambon was elected Representative of the 2nd District of Lanao del Sur in 1998, succeeding Pangalian Balindong, who had held the seat from 1995 to 1998.

He served three consecutive terms, covering the 11th, 12th, and 13th Congress of the Philippines, until 2007.

As a member of the House of Representatives, his work included drafting and filing legislation, representing the interests of his district's constituents, participating in congressional committees, and contributing to national policy discussions affecting Muslim Mindanao.

His tenure coincided with significant national debates on Bangsamoro autonomy and the ongoing peace process with the MNLF and the Moro Islamic Liberation Front (MILF).

Kabalikat ng Malayang Pilipino (KAMPI)
Moro National Liberation Front (MNLF)

Legislative Office

Representative, 2nd District of Lanao del Sur House of Representatives of the Philippines 1998 to 2007 (Three consecutive terms)

Prior Legislative Service

Assemblyman, 2nd District of Lanao del Sur 3rd ARMM Regional Legislative Assembly (1996 to 2001)

Earlier Government Service

Member, Sangguniang Pampook (Regional Assembly), Region XII Designated December 29, 1987

Post-Congressional Appointment

Board Member and Director, Subic Bay Metropolitan Authority (SBMA) Appointed by President Rodrigo Duterte, 2018 Served until September 22, 2022

Notability

Three-term Representative of the 2nd District of Lanao del Sur (1998 to 2007), MNLF leader, and advocate for the ecological protection of Lake Lanao.

Known For

Authoring legislation on education and cooperative broadcasting; infrastructure development across Lanao del Sur; post-

LEGISLATIVE WORK

Macarambon authored numerous House bills during his congressional service.

Among the legislation he authored that became law:

Republic Act No. 8912 created a secondary school in the municipality of Sultan Gumander, Lanao del Sur.

Republic Act No. 9171 granted the Muslim Development Multipurpose Cooperative a broadcast franchise.

The Senate Legislative Reference Bureau also records his authorship of measures providing for the construction of infrastructure across Lanao del Sur, including municipal halls, bridges, roads, and sports development centers in municipalities such as Tugaya, Marogong, Balabagan, Ganassi, and Madalum.

He likewise authored bills establishing and expanding schools, including measures creating national high schools in Malabang and Balabagan, and converting the Balabagan Trade School into a state polytechnic college.

POST-CONGRESSIONAL CAREER

After completing his three terms in the House, Macarambon ran for Governor of Lanao del Sur in the 2007 elections under Kabalikat ng Malayang Pilipino (KAMPI) but was unsuccessful.

In 2018, President Rodrigo Duterte appointed him as a member of the Board of Directors of the Subic Bay Metropolitan Authority (SBMA), where he represented the business and investment sectors.

He replaced outgoing board member Stefani C. Sano in that post.

His appointment papers were signed on May 8, 2018, and his term ran until September 22, 2022.

ADVOCACY

Beyond his legislative record, Macarambon has been a consistent advocate for the ecological protection of Lake Lanao, one of the most significant bodies of water in Mindanao and a lake of deep cultural and ecological importance to the Maranao people and the broader Lanao del Sur community.

MNLF AFFILIATION

Macarambon is identified as a leader of the Moro National Liberation Front, the historic Bangsamoro organization founded by Nur Misuari that played a central role in negotiating the first formal peace agreement between the Bangsamoro and the Philippine government under the 1996 Final Peace Agreement.

His affiliation with the MNLF situates him within the tradition of Bangsamoro leaders who pursued autonomy and recognition through both armed struggle and political engagement.

congressional service on the SBMA board.

Pull Quote

"His role in Congress connects local realities in Lanao del Sur with national decision-making."

PLACE IN THE BANGSAMORO NARRATIVE

Benasing Onayan Macarambon Jr. represents the generation of Bangsamoro politicians who moved between regional governance structures and the national legislature during the critical decades of the peace process.

His career arc, from the Sangguniang Pampook to the ARMM Regional Assembly to the House of Representatives to the SBMA board, reflects the layered nature of Bangsamoro political participation in Philippine institutions.

His legislative record in the House, particularly in education and infrastructure, left a concrete mark on communities in the 2nd District of Lanao del Sur.

SEE ALSO

- Lanao del Sur's 2nd congressional district
- Moro National Liberation Front
- Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
- Pangalian Balindong
- Lake Lanao
- Subic Bay Metropolitan Authority

CATEGORIES

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